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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

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Section Title(S): Within The Band

Men, however, have command over subsistence items and other commodities that can be exchanged far beyond the confines of their own bands, extending to allied and other bands and even to other peoples. Meat, being highly perishable, is exchanged only within the gathered band and between visiting and host bands. The same stricture obviously applies to the associated services of assisting in the process of skinning, gutting, and butchering carcasses and carrying meat to camp. Young men provide a subsistence service by fetching water from distant pools, for which they are not directly rewarded.

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Exchange is self-perpetuating in that a gift or service not only discharges a previous obligation but also creates a new one. A man gave a spear blade in return for a mortar and pestle, which he had asked another to make for him. This returned the favor of making the mortar and pestle, but, at the same time, the spear blade was regarded as a gift for which a return would eventually have to be made — and so it would go on, ad infinitum. Apart from this type of specified obligation to reciprocate, there are also social zones of generalized reciprocity, comparable with the generality of lending rights referred to previously. Initiation-school mates are required to help one another and to give gifts of food or artifacts when in a position to do so. There is no expectation of specific reciprocation; one mate helps another and expects that a third will help him when his own need arises. Joking relatives are obliged to grant each others' requests for goods and services and to give these priority over normal (i.e., other) exchange obligations. In theory this

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could unbalance cycles of individual reciprocation, but in practice conflict between the two sets of obligations never occurred and I did not hear of anybody having to refuse to give a gift because it had been reserved for another, that is, joking partners were neither deprived by normal exchange obligations nor did they make burdensome demands. A man is obliged to give periodic gifts to some of his avoidance relatives (e.g., his wife's parents and his sisters) without expectation of direct reciprocation. The return is more or less circuitous; females do not reciprocate, but their husbands make return on their behalf and parents reciprocate favors done for their dependent children.

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